During this period Tamil literature was dominated by Saivite and Vaishnavite literature. Kumaraguruparar, a great Saiva poet, is said to have visited Varanasi in the late seventeenth century. He composed important literary works such as Meenakshiammai Pillai Tamil and Neethineri Vilakkam. Thayumanavar wrote highly devotional verses with compassion for all humanity and he formulated a *sanmarga* that tried to bridge differences between the various Saivite sects. The Christian missionaries like Roberto de Nobili and Constantine Joseph Beschi (Veeramamunivar) contributed much to Tamil language.

The empire the Mughals built at the national level made an everlasting impact on India as they knit the fragments into a single political unit, well aided by an effective central administration. Multiple identities also got synthesized in the process leading to the evolution of a unique culture that is Indian.

Elsewhere in the World



Abbas the Great

Akbar's period, 1556 to 1605, was the period of great rulers. His nearest contemporary was Elizabeth of England. Shakespeare was living around this time. Henry IV of France, first ruler of the Bourbon dynasty, and Abbas the Great of Persia, the strongest ruler of the Safavid dynasty, were ruling their kingdoms during his period. The revolt of the Netherlands against Spanish rule in Europe that commenced during this period lasted for about eighty years and ended in 1648.

SUMMARY

- The four battles Babar fought to establish Mughal dynastic rule is described.
- Humayun's difficulties because of his brothers and hostility of Afghans and Bahadur Shah of Gujarat leading to the rise of Sur dynasty are explained.
- Rise of Sher Shah and his revenue and fiscal measures are highlighted
- Akbar's mansabdari system and inclusive religious policy as well as consolidation of Mughal rule through military conquests, notably the second Battle of Panipat, are dealt with.
- Jahangir's lack of interest in governance and Nur Jahan functioning as defacto ruler are discussed.
- Shah Jahan's Taj Mahal, epitome of Mughal architecture, and the war of succession fought among his three sons are elaborated.
- The constant wars between Mughals led by Aurangzeb and Marathas represented by Shivaji along with Aurangzeb's Rajput and Deccan policies are related.
- The salient features of Mughal society are detailed.

EXERCISE

L1S6P2

I. Choose the Correct Answer

1. Babur won the First Battle of Panipat in 1526 with the effective use of _____
   (a) Infantry (b) Cavalry
   (c) Artillery (d) Elephant corps
2. Battle of Ghagra was the last battle fought by Babur against_____
   (a) Afghans (b) Rajputs
   (c) Turks (d) Marathas
3. _____won the Battle of Chausa due to his superior political and military skills.
   (a) Babur (b) Humayun
   (c) Sher khan (d) Akbar
4. _____is a land tenure system in which the collection of the revenue of an estate and the power of governing it were bestowed upon on official of the state.
   (a) Jagirdari (b) Mahalwari
   (c) Zamindari (d) Mansabdari
5. The fiscal administration of Akbar was largely based on the methods of ----------
   (a) Babur (b) Humayun
   (c) Sher Shah (d) Ibrahim Lodi

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